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Dorjiphu Shingmen Tshogpa Management Plan



Karmaling Gewog
Plan Period: 2024-2034



Supported by:
Federal Ministry
for the Environment, Nature Conservation
and Nuclear Safety

based on a decision of the German Bundestag



Approval sheet

Executive Summary

The Dorjiphu Shingmen Tshogpa was the oldest Non-Wood Forest Products (NWFPs) group initially formed in the year 2014, with the funding supported by Royal Government of Bhutan and technical backstopping from Range office Lhamoizingkha. The group consists of 30 members from six villages: Dorjiphu, Semchungthang, Ganglingna, Namling, Jemathang and Kusumbari. The farmers of these villages depend on forest for food, shelter and water from time of ancestor. Though there were varieties of NWFPs, the most promising NWFP is Pipla (*Piper mullesua* and *Piper longum*). The locality is blessed with abundance of piper in the locality which can fetch higher rate in the market.

The review and amendment of management plans upon the conclusion of their designated periods are of paramount importance. Consequently, the initial revision of the management plan occurred in 2018, following a five-year implementation period. However, the progression of the group was impeded by the onset of the COVID-19 pandemic, leading to stagnation in advancement, compounded by a lack of support and encouragement from relevant authorities. Subsequently, the successful execution of the second plan revision in 2024 was made possible through financial backing from the International Climate Initiatives (IKI). This revised management plan is slated to span the forthcoming decade, encompassing the timeframe from 2024 to 2034.

Among various non-wood forest products that are frequently gathered from the forest, two notable examples are pipla and broom. As part of the management plan revision, it was decided to maintain a fixed collection of three specific products: *Piper mullesua*, *Piper longum*, and *Thysanolaena latifolia*. These items will be collected from designated areas including Gayri Tol, Tarikhola, Thulo Allay, Bichkhola-Madalay, Namling, Dharapani, Odhalay, Kusumbari, Dalbari Right and Left, and Balabas.

The Dorjiphu Shingmen Tshogpa effectively administered their group and successfully obtained the necessary products to meet their demands from the designated collection site over a span of nine years. Over the course of the last five years, they managed to collect a total of 418.5 kilograms in 2021, 190 kilograms in 2022, and 446 kilograms in 2023. Consequently, within this time period, the Dorjiphu Shingmen Tshogpa accumulated a total of 1054.5 kilograms of pipla from their management area and subsequently sold it in the market for a grand total of Nu.196360. Presently, the group holds Nu.19918.33/- within their joint account.

The Dorjiphu chiwog boasts a comprehensive array of essential amenities, including drinking water supply systems that cater to all households, universal access to electricity, well-connected farm roads, an efficient irrigation channel, an Oral Rehydration Center (ORC), and a dedicated chiwog meeting hall. However, it is worth noting that farmers in the area must travel a distance of 13 kilometers to avail themselves of other crucial facilities in Lhamoizingkha.

The primary crops cultivated by these farmers consist of rice, maize, and millets primarily for self-consumption purposes. Their cash income primarily stems from the sale of Areca nuts in the Indian market as well as local vegetable sales. Additionally, on occasion they supply vegetables to Thimphu. Furthermore, some households generate income through off-farm activities such as providing machinery services (power chainsaw and power tillers), engaging in daily wage work or subcontracting assignments. The annual household income for these farmers ranges from Nu. 30,000/- to Nu. 365,000/- per household.

The Management Plan is framed in such a manner that it is understandable by every member of the group and it is applicable while implementing the planned activities. There will be equitable benefit sharing among the group member without discrimination. There will be sustainable management of NWFPs and at the same time improve rural household through sale of Product. Conserve natural resources by the community by reducing illegal harvesting and facilitate in generating government revenue through proper legal channel. Provide platform for Forestry official to timely monitoring of the group and provide timely backstopping to the group.

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Part - A

NWFP Management & Marketing Plan

1. Background

The Dorjiphu Shingmen Tshogpa is comprised of 30 households with total collection area covering 189.7 hectares within the attitude range of 140 meters to 895 meters from sea level under Karmaling Gewog, Dagana Dzongkhag. The NWFP user group consists of single ethnic group called *Ihotshamps* living in the village with the high dependency on forest resources from the time of their ancestors.

This management plan has been prepared with the technical support of Dagana Forest Division, Dagapela, Lhamoizingkha Range and Forestry In-charge, Karmaling. The management plan presented herein is created with the aim of ensuring effective management of Non-Wood Forest Products (NWFP) for the next ten years following its initial ten-year establishment and operation period. The primary objective prioritized by the user group is to achieve comprehensive protection and sustainable utilization of these products.

The committee members were elected based on their merits, taking into consideration their past and present contributions to the village. They are entrusted with the responsibility to carry out their duties in a fair and impartial manner. These individuals hold a strong commitment towards the conservation of the forest and are determined to safeguard it from any form of individual greed, ensuring both present and future benefits for all.

The management plan comprises two distinct sections: the Management Plan itself and the By-laws. The purpose of the Management Plan is to outline strategies for effectively managing, utilizing, and safeguarding resources in a sustainable manner. Conversely, the focus of the By-laws is to address legal matters pertaining to resource allocation among members, membership arrangements, fund regulation, user group roles and responsibilities, as well as penalties and fines for any breaches arising within the user group.

2. Goal and objectives

- Sustainable management of NWFPs for future generation
- Income generation through sale of NWFPs
- To elevate poverty and improve the livelihood of the community
- Control illegal activities
- Socio-economic development without discrimination

3. Description of NWFPs present in the demarcated area for management

In the following table, the description on the NWFPs present in the demarcated area are shown for each season for effective management and sustainable harvesting.

Table 1. Brief description of NWFPs for commercial harvesting in each season/year

NWFPs Name	Harvesting area (s) (Name)	Parts Harvested	Use/purpose (Traditional and others)	Harvesting Season (Months)	Estimated quantity for harvest in a season/year
<i>Piper mullesua</i>	Beachkhola-Madaley	Fruits	Medicinal	August - September	351 kg
	Oadhaley				
	Kusumbari				
	Dhalbari				
	Namling				
	Gayri Tol				
	Dharapani				
	Thulo Alley				
	Tarikhola				
	Balabas				
<i>Piper longum</i>	Bich-Khola-Madaley	Fruits	Medicinal	15 th March-15 th April	30 kg
	Gayri Tol				
	Thulo Alley				
<i>Thysanolaena latifolia</i>	Beachkhola	Stems	Broom	December-March	100 head loads
	Dalbari Highway				
	Namling				

3. Harvesting prescription for sustainable NWFPs harvesting

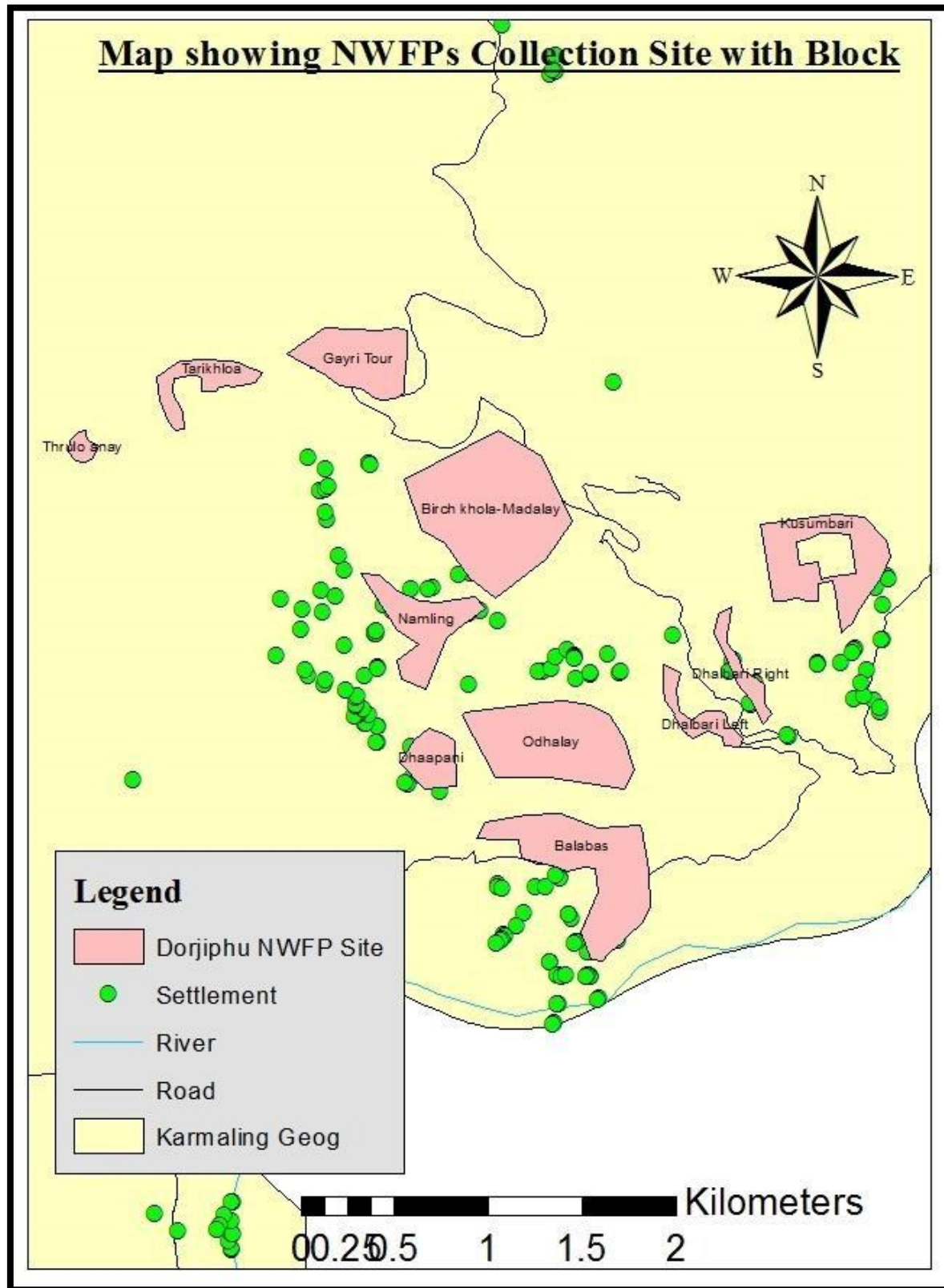
Harvesting prescriptions are necessary to prevent overexploitation, ensure regeneration of harvested species, and sustain the ecological balance of forest ecosystems, benefiting both communities and the environment.

Table 2. Harvesting prescription for sustainable harvesting

NWFPs Species	Harvesting prescription for sustainable harvesting
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<i>Piper mullesua</i>	• Hand picking the matured fruits and leaving the premature till it reaches the maturity. • Harvesting fruit only without damaging, cutting or uprooting the entire plant. • No one will be allowed to collect other than the group members. • Harvest the fruit only after date announced by chairman or as per management plan. • No single member is allowed to harvest the product by its own and for self-benefit.
<i>Piper longum</i>	• Hand picking by climbing host tree or use ladders. • Hand picking the matured fruits and leaving the premature till it reaches the maturity. • Do not fell the host tree to ease the collection.
	• Harvesting fruit only without damaging, cutting or uprooting the entire Climber. • Harvest the fruit only after date announce by chairman or as per management plan.
<i>Thysanolaena latifolia</i> (Amliso LH)	• Do not damage the rhizome in order to allow natural regeneration. • Cut the matured stem right from base.

4. Map of Dorjiphu Shingmen Tshogpa



5. Marketing and sale plan

The marketing and sale plan of the NWFP group involves identifying potential buyers, negotiating fair prices, and ensuring timely delivery of products. The group aims to increase market access and plan to implement transparent pricing mechanisms.

Table 3. Marketing and Sale Plan of the Group

NWFPS	Potential Market/Buyer	Estimated quantity for sale per season (Unit)	Form of products (Dry/fresh)	Expected price per Unit	Total (Nu)
<i>Piper mullesua</i>	India/Bhutan	351kg	Dry	200/-	70,200/-
<i>Piper longum</i>	India/Bhutan	30 Kg	Dry	250/-	7,500/-
<i>Thysanolaena latifolia</i>	Thimphu/Phuntsholing	80 Headload (15 pcs per head Load)	Dry	30/-	36,000/-

6. Marketing arrangement

In accordance with the specified timeframe outlined in the table, it is imperative for the Chairperson to secure a collection permit from the Range office prior to announcing the designated date for fruit collection. Once said permit has been obtained, the Chairperson shall proceed with making an announcement regarding the scheduled collection date accordingly.

The collection or harvesting of Non-Wood Forest Products (NWFPs) shall be carried out individually, and all collected items must be properly dried and stored in the respective households. Subsequently, the Chairman, along with the designated Range Focal Person, shall diligently search for potential markets. The sale of these products will be conducted collectively by the group.

Upon identifying a suitable market, a fixed rate will be established for the products. Each member is then responsible for either transporting their products to the specified location or delivering them to the road head upon receiving instructions from the Chairperson. During weighing procedures, it is mandatory for each individual to witness their own product's assessment.

The distribution of entitled shares shall take place based on the quantity of NWFPs collected by each member after deducting necessary fees such as Community Development

Fund contributions, Royalty payments, and compensation for work completed by members of the executive committee.

7. Benefit sharing

The revenue generated from the sale of Non-Wood Forest Products (NWFPs) will serve as an alternative income source for individual farmers, enabling them to financially support their families and meet various expenses. Additionally, this income will facilitate the sustainable management of resources, ensuring their availability for future generations.

By capitalizing on market opportunities and effectively selling their products, the group can provide livelihood support to numerous households within the village. This contribution towards poverty alleviation aligns with the objective of achieving Gross National Happiness Goals. Furthermore, during times of difficulty faced by any group member, these collective efforts enable welfare assistance to be extended to those in need within the community.

PART – B

By-Laws

1. Membership arrangement

- The native of village with registered Thram with the chiwog will be given first chance for membership.
- Outsiders who are not native to the chiwog but have purchased land and possess Thram within the chiwog will be given a free and fair opportunity for membership.
- Dual membership is not allowed

1.1. Eligibility of new memberships

The NWFPMG shall register a new member only after under stated procedure:

- Interested member shall put up an application to Chairperson of the Group.
- New member shall pay 100% of the membership fee or annual fee from initiation of group till date.
- The above criteria shall cover for native, bifurcated household and outsider.

1.2. Procedure for withdrawal from membership

- For voluntarily withdrawal from group shall not receive any benefit and shall not be entertained to rejoin the group in future
- But for those who are forced to withdraw because of situation and old age (genuine reason) would receive benefit of 80 % of his/her total share provided he/she does not have any dues with group.
- The person withdrawing must write a withdrawal application to the Chairperson of the group.

2. Responsibility and rights of the members

Each and every member of the group is responsible for:

- Managing and harvesting of NWFPs on sustainable manner.
- Cross check illegal activities within the member and also by outsiders.
- Each member has right to harvest the product from designated area allotted to them within the timeline framed in By-laws.
- Each member has right to know the status of financial transparency matter and fund utilization.
- Every member should ask or obtain Money receipt or sign in proper register while making payments.
- Members have right to vote new executive member if it is necessary.

3. Executive committee of NWFP management and marketing group

Sl. No.	Post and Name	Responsibility
1	Khamba Singh Monger, <i>Chairperson</i> Contact: 17829108	- To facilitate and coordinate meeting - Resolve dispute and conflict among member. - Maintain contact with trader and coordinate marketing of product. - Prepare and present progress report if needed. - Obtain collection permit and announce collection date of product to member. - Cross check the account check and balance timely.
2	Ash Maya Limbu, <i>Secretary</i> Contact: 77272991	- Support Chairperson in carrying out his responsibilities - Officiate the Chairperson in his absence - Support Chairperson in keeping records of meetings.
3	Kumar Pradhan, <i>Treasurer</i> Contact: 17528609	- Maintain cash transaction records by recording name and get signed while making payment or during collection in clean register. - Collect timely membership fee, group fund, fines and penalties and deposit in bank within 1 month. - Present financial report to group member during meeting - Maintain group account and take care of financial arrangement.

3.1. Tenure of committee member

Sl. No	Committee member	Tenure
1	Chairperson	10 years
2	Secretary	10 years
3	Treasurer	10 years

3.2. Incentives to the committee members

Sl. No	Committee members	Incentives
1	Chairperson	4 % of total income through sale of NWFPS
2	Secretary	2 % of total income through sale of NWFPS
3	Treasurer	3 % of total income through sale of NWFPS

Note: Transportation cost shall be deducted from gross revenue for sale of product.

4. Source for generation of group fund

Sl. No	Source of fund	Remarks
1	Membership Fee	Annually nu.100 will be collected as membership fee in the month of January to February.
2	Sale of NWFPs	3% of total income through sale of NWFPs will be deposited in group account.
3	Fines and penalties	Absentee's fines in work or meeting will be collected and fines for late fee will be collected, fines for illegal collection or collection beyond harvesting guidelines.
4	Others	Donation and Entry fee from new member.

5. Group fund management and utilization

The Dorjiphu Shingmen Tshogpa decided and agreed not to use fund unless the accumulation of amount sealing of Nu 100,000 (One Hundred Thousand) in common account. After that utilization of fund will be based upon necessities as per decision taken by the member. The one provision was discussed and agreed by member fund will be used for procurement of stationary items whenever needed for smooth flow of group.

6. Conflict Resolution

- If any individual member found to be guilty and misusing cash will be dealt as per the by-laws.
- In case disputes or conflicts arise among members regarding the access to certain area for NWFPs collection, the matter shall be forwarded to the Geog administration and Range office for further discussion.
- Conflict or disputes within Dorjiphu Shingmen Tshogpa which cannot be resolved by group members shall be forwarded to Executive committee member. If case cannot be resolve than shall be forwarded to Geog administration and range office.
- In case, if there is conflict between the NWFP collection group and outsiders, the case shall be forwarded to Geog administration and range office by Executive committee member.

7. Meetings

General meeting shall be conducted once a year and in the month of February.

8. Fines and Penalties

Sl. No	Particulars	Fines and Penalties
1	Absentee in work and meetings	• Fine of Nu.500/- per occasion. • With genuine reason shall be exempted upon receiving proper information (phone call) and verification by nearby household member. • 15 minutes late will be considered and punishment will be imposed for crossing stipulated time (Cleaning, mopping and hall arrangement)
2	Late payment of fee	• Shall impose additional of Nu.100 per month. • Crossing 3-month, member shall be automatically terminated from membership without benefit
3	Collection and sale not adherence to group agreed norms	• Double the market price.
4	Misuse of group fund	• Double the amount misused by committee member
5	Executive member Fail to carry out their duties	• Fine of Nu.500/- per occasion.
6	Member not obeying to committee member	• Fine of Nu.500/- per occasion.
Note: All fines shall be paid within week and late payment shall meet committee member for further action.		

9. Block Information

Sl. No	Block Name	Area_Ha	GPS Coordinate Northing	GPS Coordinate Easting
1	Kusumbari	21.81	26°45'43.12"N	89°53'24.18"E
2	Bich Khola-Madaley	48.27	26°45'50.42"N	89°52'27.50"E
3	Dhalbari Left	5.29	26°45'15.49"N	89°53'9.52"E
4	Dhalbari Right	4.37	26°45'23.60"N	89°53'15.19"E
5	Namling	14.58	26°45'32.03"N	89°52'13.62"E
6	Gayri Tol	16.91	26°46'17.18"N	89°52'1.54"E
7	Tarikhola	7.79	26°46'15.97"N	89°51'32.83"E
8	Thrulo Allay	1.75	26°46'2.37"N	89°51'8.23"E
9	Balabas	30.01	26°44'53.62"N	89°52'42.23"E
10	Odhalay	31.01	26°45'11.68"N	89°52'39.78"E
11	Dharapani	6.97	26°45'8.47"N	89°52'16.62"E

12. Membership List

Sl.No	Name	CID No	Village	Signature
1	Pujan Mongar	10312000688	Dorjiphu	
2.	Khamba Jig Mongar	11304002234	Dorjiphu.	
3	Dhan Maya Mongar	31304000068	Dorjiphu.	
4	Rup Maya Karki	11304002269	Dorjiphu.	
5	Jancha Maya Subba	11304000555	Dorjiphu.	
6.	Himali Moti Limboo	11304000363	Dorjiphu.	
7.	Maya Subba.	11304002189	Dorjiphu.	
8	Suk Moti Rai	1130900893	Dorjiphu	
9.	Sita Devi Rai	11309002130	Dorjiphu.	
10	Suk Moti Subba	11309000556	Dorjiphu.	
11	Arjun Limboo	11304002166	Dorjiphu.	
12	Dhan Maya Limboo	11304000870	Dorjiphu.	
13.	Harka Bir Limboo	10312000694	Kusumbasi	
14.	Khem Prasad Karki	11309000688	Dorjiphu.	
15	Sita Maya Subba.	30309000047	Dorjiphu.	
16.	Ash Maya Limboo	10312000720	Kusumbasi.	
17	Shreeaman Gurung	11304000180	Jemathana	

19.	Nima Choki Sherpa	10309003850	Jemathang	
20	Kumar Padhan.	11309001166	Dorjiphu.	
21	Pem Doki Sherpa	11304001648	Jemathang	
22.	Bee Maya Subba	11309001505	Kusumbare.	
23.	Dali Maya Limboo	11304000496	Jemathang.	
24.	Sun? Raj Limboo	11304002815	Dorjiphu.	
→ 18.	Buckhi Maya Limbo	11304002192	Dorjiphu.	
25.	Mon Maya Gurung	11304000005	Jemathang	
26	Nanda Lal Gurung	11304000012	Jemathang	
27	Mongal Singh Monges	11304000484	Namling.	
28	Run Bdr Monges	11304000479	Namling.	
29.	Suraj Kumar Subba	11304000276	Granglingna	
30.	Dhan Bdr Subba	11802001363	Namling	
31	Phib Dash Subba	11304000296	Kusumbare	
1132.	Hasta Maya Rai	11304002207	Dorjiphu	